



FIELDS OF GOLD

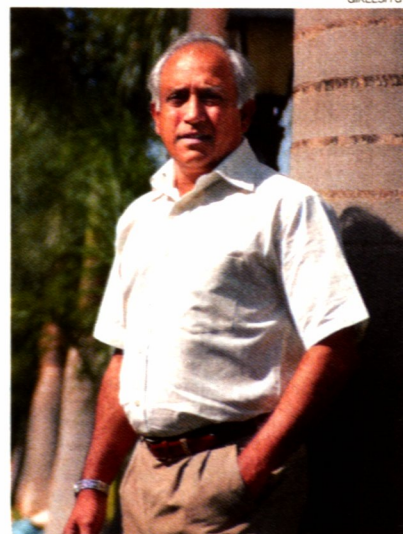
FARM LABOURERS winnow mounds of wheat on Baisakhi at a grain market near Bhatinda in Punjab. Baisakhi marks the harvest season and the beginning of the solar year in India. Punjab and Haryana alone contribute over 50 per cent of foodgrain to the country's buffer stock annually.

BANGALORE | Yoga Mission

Twenty-five years after orbiting the earth in the space station Salyut-7, Rakesh Sharma went to Moscow for the celebrations of the space flight's silver jubilee with the families of his fellow cosmonauts. The now retired wing commander was also endorsing the pros of yoga in space which he had practised to fight space sickness. Even as ISRO readies for its moon mission, Sharma wants the next Indian cosmonaut to carry forward the zero gravity yoga experiment. India's first cosmonaut's eight-day flight aboard the Soyuz T-11 spacecraft had begun on April 2, 1984 with Yuri Malyshev and Gennady Strekalov, both long gone now. During the flight, they carried out various experiments, including multi-spectral photography. Sixty-year-old Sharma is now associated with a software company in Bangalore.

by Stephen David

**SHARMA
WANTS THE
NEXT INDIAN
COSMONAUT
TO PRACTICE
ZERO
GRAVITY
YOGA WHILE
IN ORBIT TO
FIGHT SPACE
SICKNESS.**



GIREESH GV